

Is Google AI as harmful for the environment as ChatGPT?

Posted by u/Yoinker9001 • 0 points • 9 comments

For a while now, whenever you google something there is an AI summary of all the info on the first few websites. I always hear talk about how ChatGPT is horrible for the environment and should be used far more sparingly than google, but if google uses AI for the summary, is it any better?

Comments

u/sharpmada • 1 points • 2025-05-15 12:38 UTC

Life Hack: type -ai after each search so it doesn't use ai (example: how to do a pushup -ai)

u/Squidgeneer101 • 1 points • 2025-03-05 17:47 UTC

Generally data halls/centers are massive power consumers, at the scale of cities in some cases. So it all depends on how that power is generated, if that power is mostly solar, wind or hydro they aren't quite as polluting. But if they are powered by gas or coal, they are massive polluters. I don't think the halls themselves release a lot of pollutants on their own. Most of the CO2 most likely comes from the overhead.

u/Major_Enthusiasm1099 • 1 points • 2025-03-05 17:42 UTC

They both need loads and loads of processing power which is gonna be on some server farm that is God knows where and to power those server farms requires the energy of fossil fuels so yes it is as harmful

u/bangbangracer • 3 points • 2025-03-05 17:37 UTC

For the most part they are roughly the same. It's all using data centers crunching data.

u/dansdansy • 1 points • 2025-03-05 17:33 UTC

Google's energy consumption for AI inference is way lower than everyone else's since they use special chips called TPUs designed for the workload. OpenAI/Anthropic/Meta/X etc use chips that burn a lot more energy.

u/TheApiary • 2 points • 2025-03-05 17:32 UTC

Yeah, it's the exact same thing. But the good news is that how bad individual AI use is for the environment is pretty overhyped. Asking ChatGPT a question takes about the same amount of energy as watching Netflix for one minute, which most people don't worry about much.

A lot of people don't like AI for reasonable reasons, like it's making it really hard for artists to have jobs

and it's filling the internet with slop, and then are trying to make it sound terrible in every way, when in reality, on energy use, it's not really worse than other internet products.

u/Yoribell • 1 points • 2025-03-05 18:24 UTC

And most internet product use barely anything, I had people stressing about mail, google searches, page loading... But they don't see any problem with AC, high luminosity screens, using car when they could walk etc..

u/TheApiary • 2 points • 2025-03-05 18:28 UTC

This post has a bunch of helpful comparisons!

<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/individual-ai-use-is-not-bad-for>

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-03-05 17:29 UTC

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u/Longjumping-Sweet280 • 1 points • 2025-03-05 17:27 UTC

nope -_- which sucks that each time you just wanna Google something you're basically complicit